

Survey to assess AI literacy of respondents in SIA for planning of AI course for Architects

10 x MCQs to be replied after scanning a QR code - reply will auto input to a google sheet.

Q1 **Foundational**

What does the term 'generative AI' best describe?

- A Software that automates repetitive drafting tasks such as dimensioning and hatching
- B AI that creates new content — text, images, or designs — based on a user's prompt or instruction**
- C A BIM plugin that generates clash reports automatically
- D A program that optimises project schedules using historical data

Q2 **Foundational**

Which of the following is the best example of AI already embedded in tools architects routinely use?

- A Exporting a PDF from Revit
- B Automated clash detection and coordination checking in BIM platforms**
- C Creating a new layer in AutoCAD
- D Compressing a large drawing file for email

Q3 **Applied**

What is 'prompt engineering' in the context of using AI tools?

- A Writing code in Python to build a custom AI system
- B Designing structural load prompts for engineering consultants
- C Crafting clear, specific instructions to guide an AI tool towards the output you need**
- D Engineering the physical hardware that powers AI servers

Q4 **Applied**

An architect wants to rapidly explore 30 different massing configurations for a site. Which AI tool type is most suited to this task?

- A A grammar and spell-checking AI
- B Generative design or AI-assisted parametric tools that can produce and evaluate multiple options simultaneously**
- C An AI email summariser
- D A PDF text extraction tool

Q5 **Critical**

What is 'AI hallucination'?

- A An AI-generated photorealistic rendering that looks too real to be a visualisation
- B When an AI confidently produces information that is incorrect, fabricated, or nonsensical
- C A VR walkthrough experience powered by AI
- D When an AI model runs too slowly due to insufficient computing power

Q6 **Ethics / Legal**

An architect uses an AI tool to generate a schematic design concept. Who retains legal and professional responsibility for the design's compliance with local building codes?

- A The company that developed the AI tool
- B The client who commissioned the design
- C The cloud platform hosting the AI
- D The architect of record

Q7 **Foundational**

How do Large Language Models (LLMs) such as ChatGPT or Claude generate their responses?

- A They search the live internet and compile up-to-date facts in real time
- B They access a continuously updated database of all published books and articles
- C They predict the most statistically likely next word or phrase based on patterns learned from vast training data
- D They connect directly to your files and documents to produce personalised answers

Q8. **Critical**

What is the most significant professional risk when using AI to assist with architectural specification writing?

- A AI cannot type quickly enough to meet project deadlines
- B AI may confidently generate outdated, inaccurate, or jurisdiction-specific clauses that require expert verification before use
- C AI-generated specifications are more expensive to print and distribute
- D AI tools require specialist hardware that most practices cannot afford

Q9 **Applied**

Which statement most accurately describes how AI image generation tools handle architectural spatial requirements?

- A They accurately interpret and enforce spatial constraints, structural logic, and building regulations
- B They produce visually convincing images but do not understand spatial logic, structure, scale, or code compliance
- C They are trained specifically on architectural drawings and can produce technically accurate floor plans
- D They automatically cross-reference outputs with local planning guidelines

Q10 **Self-assessment**

Which statement best describes your current level of AI tool use in your architectural practice?

- A I do not use any AI tools and have no immediate plans to explore them
- B I am aware of AI tools but have not yet tried any in a professional context
- C occasionally use AI tools (e.g. ChatGPT, image generators) for specific tasks but not as a regular workflow
- D I regularly integrate AI tools into my daily practice across multiple project tasks

Here's how the 10 questions are structured :

Question breakdown by category:

- Q1–2: Foundational awareness (what AI is, where it already exists in practice)
- Q3–4: Applied skills (prompt engineering, generative design)
- Q5, 8: Critical thinking (hallucinations, specification risks)
- Q6: Ethics & legal responsibility
- Q7: Technical understanding (how LLMs actually work)
- Q9: Tool limitations (image generation vs. technical accuracy)
- Q10: Self-assessment of adoption level (no wrong answer — used to segment cohorts)

Scoring maps to 4 course tiers:

- 0–3 → Foundational awareness module
- 4–6 → Applied AI tools workshop
- 7–9 → AI strategy & ethics masterclass
- 10 → Peer-led AI practice group